



The external SSD market in 2024 continues to deliver compact, high-speed storage solutions for users who need portability without compromising performance. This year, the focus has been on refining existing technologies, offering higher capacities and better transfer speeds while keeping costs competitive. Although, here in India, we don't get to see the devices with the higher transfer speeds that much.

A couple of years ago we had external SSDs with 2000 MBps launch in India but those seem to have made way for the older 1000 MBps drives which are cheaper. Since interfaces with higher transfer speeds aren't all that common, most customers are more than happy with 1000 MBps drives and the market is flooded with them. In fact, folks wanting better performance can opt for NVMe housings which offer the best speeds. With external SSDs, there are a lot of value-added services or features being offered.

We've been seeing Adobe subscriptions for some time along with data recovery software licenses. But these are not exactly unique. Some manufacturers have started bundling rugged designs and weatherproofing features, targeting outdoor professionals and travelers. However, the number of companies which are actually innovating are in

the minority, and boy do they charge a premium for their offerings. All in all, 2024 turned out to be just another year where external SSDs struggled to lose the commodity label. Here's a look at the winners.

Winner and Best Buy: Kingston XS1000

The Kingston XS1000 is the definitive choice for 2024, winning both the Zero1 Award and the Best Buy accolade. This portable SSD combines lightning-fast performance with affordability, making it a standout option for users across the board.

With sequential read speeds of up to 1,050 MBps, the XS1000 is perfect for tasks like transferring large files, running portable applications, or creating backups on the go.

Its compact design, roughly the size of a key fob, ensures easy portability, while the robust build quality gives users peace of mind during travel. The plug-and-play compatibility with both Windows and macOS further enhances its appeal. At a highly competitive price, the Kingston XS1000 is an unbeatable value for money, offering performance and convenience that rivals far more expensive options.

Runner-Up:

Synology BeeDrive

The Synology BeeDrive stands out for its unique approach to external storage, focusing on seamless data backup. While it doesn't quite match the raw speed of the Kingston XS1000, the BeeDrive compensates with intelligent features such as automatic file syncing and multi-version backups. It's a perfect choice for users who prioritise data protection over sheer performance.

The BeeDrive is also compact and lightweight, making it a practical companion for daily use. Its software suite is user-friendly, enabling effortless backup for critical data. While priced slightly higher, the BeeDrive's focus on backup functionality gives it an edge for users looking for a reliable data protection solution.

Synology is one of the few companies who's value added offerings actually set them apart from the competition but with an eye-watering price tag, the vast number of consumers would think twice before opting for one of their drives. That being said, it's also one of the few companies who's products pretty much command the price tag that they ship with.

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External SSDs

Fast storage on the go



Kingston XS1000
Price: ₹11,999 (2 TB)



Synology BeeDrive
Price: ₹23,999 (2 TB)